he owned, Sulṭān Maḥmūd's dominions from Qaḥlūgha (also known as the Iron Gate) to the range of Hindū Kush. Babur tells an interesting anecdote regarding this.

Once his old manikin, a tax-gatherer named Ḥasan Barlās, had made Babur march and halt from Aīlāk to Aūbāj. Against Babur's will, he had used all the tax-gatherer's roughness. But now he stood abased and stripped of power with no blow struck, no command over servants, goods or life, and left with merely 300 men. Today he appeared as defeated and destitute as Babur once was.

And on the same very evening of the day when Khusrau Shāh had returned to the camp, Mīrzā Khān came to seek audience with Babur. Full of aggression and anguish, he demanded vengeance on Khusrau Shāh for the blood of his brothers. Baysonghor Sulṭān Mīrzā was shot by an arrow while Sulṭān Mas'ūd Mīrzā was blinded. Although Babur along with his men firmly believed that Mīrzā Khān's demand was right by law and common justice, and a man like him needed to be treated by an iron fist, Khusrau Shāh was let go scot-free. Of course, he had to be given the deal that Babur was in with him. An order was passed that Khusrau Shāh should be allowed to take whatever of his goods he could convey. Accordingly, he loaded up, on four strings of scuffs and camels. He carried all jewels, gold, silver and other precious things he had. Sherīm ṭaghāī was told to escort him. After setting Khusrau Shāh on his road for Khurāsān, Babur was to go to Kāhmard by the way of Ghūrī, Dahānah and bring the families to Kābul.

Babur Heads Out for Kābul

After setting Khusrau Shāh out, Babur and his party began to march towards Kābul. En route, they halted at Khwāja Zaid. On the same day, Ḥamza Bī Mangfīt was overrunning at the head of Aūzbeg raiders around Dūshī. Babur sent the lords of the gate, Sayyid Qāsim and Aḥmad-i-qāsim Kohbur, with several warriors to counter Ḥamza Bī Mangfīt. They ferociously attacked the Aūzbegs. As a celebratory note, they brought back the heads of some they had beheaded.

Babur got complete control of Khusrau Shāh's armoury. There were around 800 coats-of-mail and horse accoutrements. Babur also got his hands on a few marvellous works of porcelain. These were the only good things salvaged from the leftovers.

In five sets of marches, Babur and his men reached Ghūr-bund. They dismounted in the locality of Ushtur-Shahr. Babur heard the news that Muqīm's